FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

Unit 7: Retroflex and z

ڈ ڑ ز ژ

1 In this unit

Hard ڈ vs soft ڑ; د the flapped r that never starts a word; ز; the rare Persian ژ.



How long: About 2.5 hours for a child, 1 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.

ژ ز ڑ ڈ

2 What to say and show, letter by letter

	Say	How the pen moves	Often mixed up with
ڈ	**ḍāl** ڈال hard English 'd' in dad, tongue curled back	top down and out to the left in one angled stroke, then the small ط sign on top, last	dāl
ڑ	**ṛe** ڑے a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue curled back (no English match)	top down and sweep left below the line, then the small ط sign on top, last	re, ze
ز	**ze** زے 'z' in zoo	top down and sweep left below the line; the dot last	re, ṛe, zhe
ژ	**zhe** ژے 's' in pleasure (Persian loanwords only, rare)	top down and sweep left below the line; the dots last	ze, re

3 How to use the sheets

1. **Trace and write**: one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
2. **Look-alikes**: circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
3. **Join the letters**: standing letters into a joined word.
4. **Read and match**: word to meaning.
5. **Reading practice**: words, sentences, story.
6. **Dictation**: the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
7. **Unit check**: 10 questions. The answer key is the last page of the unit-check PDF; in the unit pack the keys are on the last pages.

4 How to check

- **Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- **Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- **Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- **Praise** effort: “you started on the right”, “good dots”. One sheet a day beats five at once.

5 A 10-minute sitting

2 min warm-up: point to last time’s letters, the child says them. **5 min** the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. **3 min** read it back together and end on something done well.

Trace and write: ḍāl

ڈال

Name _____ Date _____

ḍāl ڈال

Sound: hard English 'd' in dad, tongue curled back

step 1: the body | step 2: the small ط sign

How the pen moves: top down and out to the left in one angled stroke, then the small ط sign on top, last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.



Alone

ڈ ڈ ڈ

Again, alone

ڈ ڈ

End of a word (the letter before it joins to it, it does not join forward)

ـڈ ـڈ

From memory: write it alone

In a word: ḍar (fear)

ڈَر

Trace and write: ṛe

ڑے

Name _____ Date _____

ṛe ڑے



Sound: a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue curled back (no English match)

step 1: the body | step 2: the small ط sign

How the pen moves: top down and sweep left below the line, then the small ط sign on top, last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

Alone



Again, alone

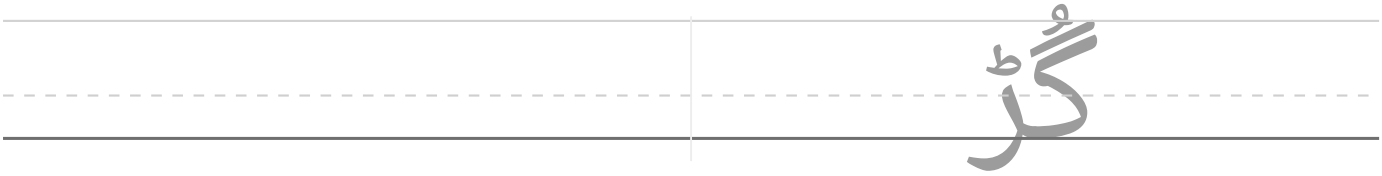


End of a word (the letter before it joins to it, it does not join forward)



From memory: write it alone

In a word: guṛ (jaggery)



Trace and write: ze

زے

Name _____ Date _____

ze زے



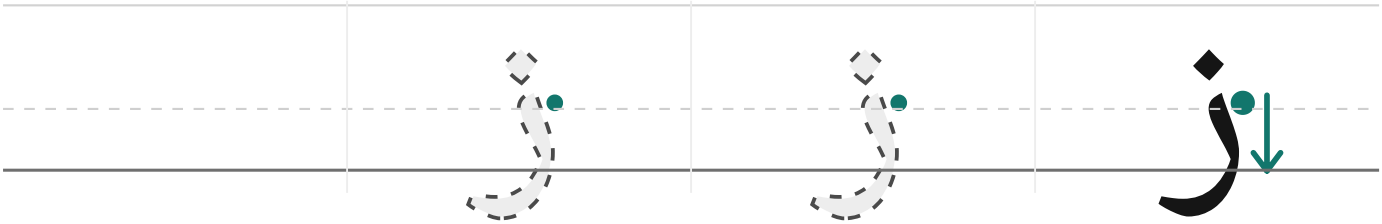
Sound: 'z' in zoo

step 1: the body | step 2: 1 dot

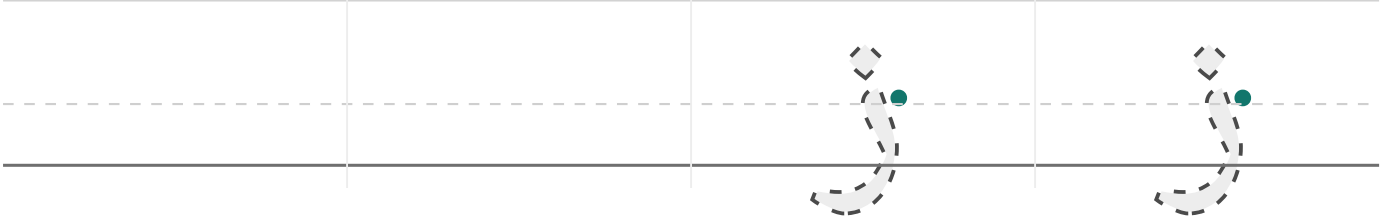
How the pen moves: top down and sweep left below the line; the dot last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

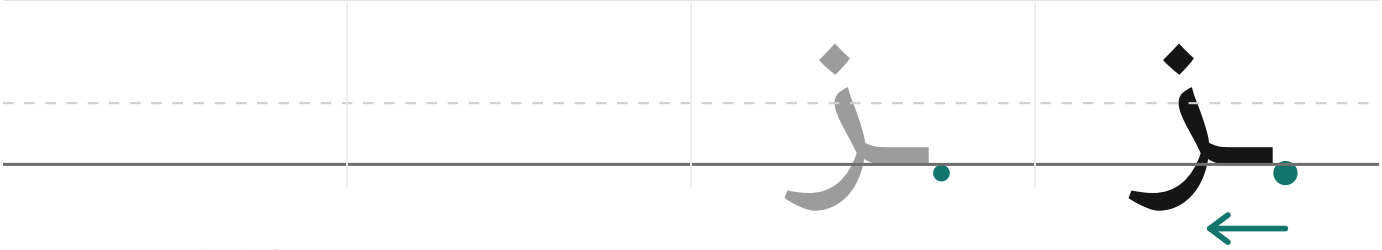
Alone



Again, alone



End of a word (the letter before it joins to it, it does not join forward)



From memory: write it alone

In a word: tez (fast, sharp)



Trace and write: zhe

ژے

Name _____ Date _____

zhe ژے



Sound: 's' in pleasure (Persian loanwords only, rare)

step 1: the body | step 2: 3 dots

How the pen moves: top down and sweep left below the line; the dots last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

Alone

ژ ژ ژ

Again, alone

ژ ژ

End of a word (the letter before it joins to it, it does not join forward)

ـژ ـژ

From memory: write it alone

In a word: zhāla (hailstone)

ژالہ

Look-alike letters

ملتے جلتے حرف

Name _____ Date _____

1 **Circle every letter that is the same as the big one on the right.**

ت	ڈ	ڈ	ز	س	د	ڈ	ڈ
ڑ	ش	ڑ	ث	ز	ژ	ر	ڑ
ی	ر	ژ	ز	ڑ	ز	ز	ز
ژ	ز	ر	ژ	گ	ژ	ں	ژ

2 **Count the dots on each letter. Write the letter again in the box with that many dots.**

د	ڑ	ر	ز	ڈ	ژ

No dots	1 dot	3 dots

Join the letters into a word

حرف جوڑیں

Name _____ Date _____

1 **The letters are standing alone. Join them into a word. Read it out loud.**

Joined letters change shape. Write the word from right to left. The first two words on each page have a grey guide to trace.

1

ڈ + ی + ڑ + ھ

Say: ḍeṛh (one and a half)

ڈیڑھ

2

زِ + ی + ا + دَ + ہ

Say: ziyāda (more, too much)

زِیادَہ

3

زَ + ب + ا + ن

Say: zabān (tongue / language)

4

زِ + ن + دَ + گ + ی

Say: zindagī (life)

Join the letters into a word

حرف جوڑیں

Name _____ Date _____

1 **The letters are standing alone. Join them into a word. Read it out loud.**

Joined letters change shape. Write the word from right to left. The first two words on each page have a grey guide to trace.

5

گ + ا + ڑ + ی

Say: gāṛī (car, vehicle)

گاڑی

6

بَ + ڑ + ی

Say: baṛī (big)

بَڑی

7

اَ + ن + گ + ر + ی + ز + ی

Say: angrezī (English)

8

بَ + ڑ + ا

Say: baṛā (big)

Read and match

لفظ ملائیں

Name _____ Date _____

1 **Read each Urdu word. Draw a line to its meaning.**

a life		1 ڈیڑھ
b tongue / language		2 زِیادَہ
c leave		3 زَبان
d English		4 زِندَگی
e doctor		5 گاڑی
f one and a half		6 اَنگریزی
g thousand		7 بَڑا
h more, too much		8 ہَزار
i big		9 ڈاکْٹَر
j car, vehicle		10 چھوڑ

Read and match

لفظ ملائیں

Name _____ Date _____

1 **Read each Urdu word. Draw a line to its meaning.**

a thing		11	تھوڑا
b earth		12	زَمین
c a little		13	تیز
d door		14	چیز
e ship, aeroplane		15	زور
f standing		16	پَڑھنے
g to read		17	دَروازَہ
h fast, sharp		18	جَہاز
i day, daily		19	روز
j strength		20	کھَڑے

Read the words

پڑھنے کی مشق

Name _____ Date _____

1 **Read each word. Colour a circle each time you read it smoothly (three tries).**

زِندَگی ○○○	زَبان ○○○	زِیادَہ ○○○	ڈیڑھ ○○○
بَڑا ○○○	اَنگریزی ○○○	بَڑی ○○○	گاڑی ○○○
چھوڑ ○○○	ڈاکْٹَر ○○○	بَڑے ○○○	ہَزار ○○○
گھڑی ○○○	لَڑْکی ○○○	زَمین ○○○	تھوڑا ○○○
سَڑَک ○○○	چیز ○○○	تیز ○○○	زِندَہ ○○○

Grown-up corner. Say a word, let the child repeat it, then point. Sounds and meanings, from the right: ḍeṛh (one and a half) · ziyāda (more, too much) · zabān (tongue / language) · zindagī (life) · gāṛī (car, vehicle) · baṛī (big) · angrezī (English) · baṛā (big) · hazār (thousand) · baṛe (big) · ḍākṭar (doctor) · chhoṛ (leave) · thoṛā (a little) · zamīn (earth) · laṛkī (girl) · ghaṛī (watch) · zinda (alive) · tez (fast, sharp) · chīz (thing) · saṛak (road)

Read the words

پڑھنے کی مشق

Name _____ Date _____

1 **Read each word. Colour a circle each time you read it smoothly (three tries).**

دَروازَہ ○○○	پَڑھنے ○○○	زور ○○○	پَڑھا ○○○
میز ○○○	چیزیں ○○○	روز ○○○	جَہاز ○○○
ڈَر ○○○	کھَڑے ○○○	روزانہ ○○○	پَڑھ ○○○
پَڑھو ○○○	لَڑکے ○○○	کھِڑکی ○○○	اَنڈے ○○○
تھوڑی ○○○	بُزُرگ ○○○	تازَہ ○○○	کھَڑی ○○○

Grown-up corner. Say a word, let the child repeat it, then point. Sounds and meanings, from the right: paṛhā (read) · zor (strength) · paṛhne (to read) · darwāza (door) · jahāz (ship, aeroplane) · roz (day, daily) · chīzeṉ (things) · mez (table) · paṛh (read) · rozāna (daily) · khaṛe (standing) · ḍar (fear) · aṇḍe (eggs) · khiṛkī (window) · laṛke (boys) · paṛho (read!) · khaṛī (standing) · tāza (fresh) · buzurg (elderly person) · thoṛī (a little)

Read the sentences

جملے پڑھیں

Name _____ Date _____

2 **Read each line twice. Slide your finger under the words, right to left. Then trace it.**

لَڑْکا سَڑَک پَر ہَے

لَڑْکا سَڑَک پَر ہَے

لَڑْکی بَڑی ہوشْیار ہَے

لَڑْکی بَڑی ہوشْیار ہَے

زَینَب روز کِتاب پَڑھتی ہَے

زَینَب روز کِتاب پَڑھتی ہَے

Read the story

کہانی پڑھیں

Name _____ Date _____

3 **Read the story. Then ask: who? where? what happened?**

زَینَب ایک ہوشیار لَڑْکی ہَے۔ وُہ روز اِسکول جاتی ہَے۔ اِسکول بازار کے پاس ہَے۔ بازار مَیں بَہُت چیزیں ہَیں۔ دُکان پَر اَنڈے اَور کَپْڑے ہَیں۔ اَنڈے تازَہ ہَیں۔ زَینَب کا اَبُّو بازار مَیں کام کَرتا ہَے۔ اَبُّو کے پاس بَڑی گاڑی ہَے۔ شام کو اَبُّو گھر جاتا ہَے۔ زَینَب اَپنی کِتاب پَڑھتی ہَے۔ زَینَب کا کَمْرہ بَہُت بَڑا ہَے۔ زَینَب کی زِندَگی بَہُت اَچّھی ہَے۔ ڈاکْٹَر کی گاڑی بَہُت تیز ہَے۔ لَڑکے بازار مَیں کھیلتے ہَیں۔ بوڑھی نانی کے پاس زیوَر ہَے۔ ڈاکْٹَر روز اِسکول جاتا ہَے۔ لَڑْکی ڈاکْٹَر کو کِتاب دیتی ہَے۔



Time it: ____ seconds. Words in the story: 94. Words per minute = 94 × 60 ÷ seconds.

For the grown-up: sounds and meanings

Read the lines aloud first, then let the child read them. Ask the three questions after the story.

1. laṛkā saṛak par hai - the boy is on the road

2. laṛkī baṛī hoshyār hai - the girl is very clever

3. zainab roz kitāb paṛhtī hai - Zainab reads a book every day

Story. zainab ek hoshyār laṛkī hai. woh roz iskūl jātī hai. iskūl bāzār ke pās hai. bāzār meṉ bahut chīzeṉ haiṉ. dukān par anḍe aur kapṛe haiṉ. anḍe tāza haiṉ. zainab kā abbū bāzār meṉ kām kartā hai. abbū ke pās baṛī gāṛī hai. shām ko abbū ghar jātā hai. zainab apnī kitāb paṛhtī hai. zainab kā kamra bahut baṛā hai. zainab kī zindagī bahut achchhī hai. ḍākṭar kī gāṛī bahut tez hai. laṛke bāzār meṉ khelte haiṉ. būṛhī nānī ke pās zewar hai. ḍākṭar roz iskūl jātā hai. laṛkī ḍākṭar ko kitāb detī hai.

Meaning. Zainab is a clever girl. She goes to school every day. The school is near the market. There are many things in the market. At the shop there are eggs and clothes. The eggs are fresh. Zainab's dad works in the market. Dad has a big car. In the evening dad goes home. Zainab reads her book. Zainab's room is very big. Zainab's life is very good. The doctor's car is very fast. The boys play in the market. Old grandma has jewellery. The doctor goes to school every day. The girl gives the doctor a book.

Listen and write

املا

Name _____ Date _____

1 **The grown-up says a word twice. Write it on the line, right to left. (The words are on the last page, for the grown-up.)**

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

Listen and write: sentences

املا

Name _____ Date _____

1 **The grown-up reads a sentence slowly, a few words at a time. Write it on the lines. (The words and sentences are on the last pages, for the grown-up.)**

1

2

3

4

Unit 7 check

جانچ

Name _____ Date _____

A grown-up reads each prompt. No help with the letters. 10 questions, about 10 minutes.

1 Say: “ṛe” (a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue curled back (no English match))

ز ڑ گ ر

2 Say: “ze” ('z' in zoo)

ز ژ ڑ ر

3 Say: “zhe” ('s' in pleasure (Persian loanwords only, rare))

ر ز ژ چ

4 How many dots does this letter have?

پ

0 1 2 3

5 Say: “thoṛī” (a little)

کھڑکی پڑھتا تھوڑی

6 Say: “balki” (rather, but also)

بَندَہ بَلکِہ وَرنہ

7 Say: “tezī” (speed)

ڈرتے نَماز تیزی

8 Join the letters and write the word. Say: “rozāna”.

ہ + ن + ا + ز + و + ر

_____

_ _

_____

9 Join the letters and write the word. Say: “ḍākṭar”.

ر + ٹَ + کْ + ا + ڈ

_____

_ _

_____

10 Read this word out loud. Tick if it was right.

ہَرگِز

☐ right ☐ needs help

Score: _____ / 10 **8 or more: ready for the next unit**

Answer key: unit 7

For the grown-up. Keep this page; the child does not need it.

Look-alike letters, part 1: circle these (counting from the right)

Letter	Circles
ڈ	1, 5, 6
ڑ	5, 7
ز	1, 2, 4
ژ	2, 4, 7

Look-alike letters, part 2: the dot boxes

Box	Letters
no dots	د ڑ ر ڈ
1 dot	ز
3 dots	ژ

Read and match: which meaning goes with each word

1 → f · 2 → h · 3 → b · 4 → a · 5 → j · 6 → d · 7 → i · 8 → g · 9 → e · 10 → c

11 → c · 12 → b · 13 → h · 14 → a · 15 → j · 16 → g · 17 → d · 18 → e · 19 → i

20 → f

Answer key: unit 7

For the grown-up. Keep this page; the child does not need it.

Join the letters: the words

#	Word	Say / meaning
1	ڈیڑھ	ḍeṛh (one and a half)
2	زِیادَہ	ziyāda (more, too much)
3	زَبان	zabān (tongue / language)
4	زِندَگی	zindagī (life)
5	گاڑی	gāṛī (car, vehicle)
6	بَڑی	baṛī (big)
7	اَنگریزی	angrezī (English)
8	بَڑا	baṛā (big)

For the grown-up: what to say

Keep this page. Say each word twice, then check the child's page against the last column.

#	Say	Meaning	Check against
1	hazār	thousand	ہَزار
2	baṛe	big	بَڑے
3	ḍākṭar	doctor	ڈاکْٹَر
4	chhoṛ	leave	چھوڑ
5	thoṛā	a little	تھوڑا
6	zamīn	earth	زَمین
7	laṛkī	girl	لَڑْکی
8	ghaṛī	watch	گھڑی
9	zinda	alive	زِندَہ
10	tez	fast, sharp	تیز
S1	laṛkā saṛak par hai (the boy is on the road)		لَڑْکا سَڑَک پَر ہَے
S2	laṛkī baṛī hoshyār hai (the girl is very clever)		لَڑْکی بَڑی ہوشْیار ہَے
S3	zainab roz kitāb paṛhtī hai (Zainab reads a book every day)		زَینَب روز کِتاب پَڑھتی ہَے
S4	ḍākṭar kī gāṛī baṛī hai (the doctor's car is big)		ڈاکْٹَر کی گاڑی بَڑی ہَے

Marking: one tick for each word spelt correctly. A missing or wrong dot makes a different letter, so it counts as wrong. Small vowel marks are a bonus until unit 11.

Unit 7 check: answer key

Correct answers are circled. If the score is under 8: redo the look-alike sheet and the trace sheet for the letters that were missed, wait a day, try again.

1 If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter

Say: “ṛe” (a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue curled back (no English match))

ز ڑ گ ر

2 If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter

Say: “ze” ('z' in zoo)

ز ژ ڑ ر

3 If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter

Say: “zhe” ('s' in pleasure (Persian loanwords only, rare))

ر ز ژ چ

4 If wrong, redo: look-alike sheet, part 2

How many dots does this letter have?

پ

0 1 2 3

5 If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice

Say: “thoṛī” (a little)

کھِڑکی پَڑھتا تھوڑی

6 If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice

Say: “balki” (rather, but also)

بَندَہ بَلکِہ وَرنہ

7 If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice

Say: “tezī” (speed)

ڈَرتے نَماز تیزی

8 If wrong, redo: join-the-letters sheet

Join the letters and write the word. Say: “rozāna”.

ہ + ن + ا + ز + و + ر

روزانہ

9 If wrong, redo: join-the-letters sheet

Join the letters and write the word. Say: “ḍākṭar”.

ر + ٹ + ک + ا + ڈ

ڈاکْٹَر

10 If wrong, redo: reading practice words

Read this word out loud. Tick if it was right.

ہَرگِز

Answer: hargiz (never)